

Which brands are being impersonated, by vertical and region

Scope: 165 brands across 14 verticals and 7 regions · **Window:** 1 January – 3 August 2026 · **Method:** rendered page content; no domain-token or permutation logic

20,008

IMPERSONATING
DOMAINS (HIGH
CONFIDENCE)

77%

CARRY NO BRAND TOKEN

126

BRANDS, UNAMBIGUOUS
MATCH

Payments

MOST TARGETED
VERTICAL

APAC

MOST TARGETED REGION

The measurement problem, and how we handled it

This started as a single league table. Validating the top of it showed that a rendered-title match does not mean the same thing for every brand, and publishing one combined ranking would have been misleading. The distinction is worth setting out before any numbers, because it changes how they should be read.

Some brands host third-party content under their own name. A page titled "Shopify" is usually a real merchant's storefront. A page titled "Airbnb in Las Vegas" is usually a real listing. A page titled "LinkedIn Outreach Automation for B2B Teams" is a real agency. None of these are impersonation, and no filter reliably separates them from the fakes at scale — we tried two and both failed.

Counted as Shopify "impersonation" by title match:

raytune.net | RayTune ハンドメイドルアー | Shopify
nossoperfume.store | Loja Shopify
foloyu.com | 创建一个电商网站, 然后进行在线销售! Shopify 提供的电商软件
— all three are genuine Shopify storefronts, not fakes.

Counted as Airbnb "impersonation":

casalouie.com | AirBnb in Las Vegas
pelionhouse4allseasons.site | Πέτρινη Κατοικία προς Πώληση Άγιος Λαυρέντιος
— both are genuine property listings.

By contrast, no bank, mobile carrier, tax authority or postal service hosts third-party pages titled after itself. A page rendering as Bank of Ireland on a domain that is not the bank's is an impersonation, with very little room for another reading. So the brands are split on exactly that property, and the headline figures use only the unambiguous set.

Class	Verticals	Brands	Domains	How to read the number
Unambiguous	Banking, Payments, Telecom, Government, Logistics, Crypto wallets, Health, Utilities	126	20,008	A direct measure of impersonation
Platform	Social, Retail marketplaces, Streaming, Tech, Travel, Gaming	39	42,150	An upper bound — includes legitimate third-party pages

We also measured how bad the platform inflation is. Sampling roughly 300 rendered titles per brand and classifying each, the share that read as the brand's own surface rather than a third party ranged from **0%** to **84%** across platform brands, against **98%** for the best of the unambiguous set. We are not publishing those sampled ratios as adjusted counts, because spot-checking showed the automated classifier itself makes errors in both directions. They are reported here only as evidence for the split.

Most targeted brands — unambiguous match

126 brands whose name is not attached to third-party content. These counts are a direct measure of impersonation.

#	Brand	Vertical	Region	Domains	Relative	Observations	No token
1	Alipay floor	Payments	APAC	1,581		3,017	99%
2	Movistar floor	Telecom	EU	1,481		1,550	97%
3	Pix floor	Payments	LATAM	1,474		2,618	97%
4	ChinaMobile floor	Telecom	APAC	1,243		1,556	100%
5	WeChatPay floor	Payments	APAC	1,093		2,287	100%
6	Binance floor	Crypto	Global	805		4,131	70%
7	BT floor	Telecom	UK	740		1,852	54%
8	PayPal	Payments	Global	637		1,385	83%
9	EE	Telecom	UK	602		977	38%
10	OKX floor	Crypto	Global	566		3,511	65%
11	Revolut	Banking	UK	545		625	79%
12	TrustWallet floor	Crypto	Global	481		4,657	53%
13	USPS	Logistics	US	460		849	88%
14	Ledger floor	Crypto	Global	392		23,882	45%
15	Santander	Banking	UK	387		647	68%
16	Coinbase floor	Crypto	Global	380		6,449	64%
17	DHL floor	Logistics	Global	362		1,190	62%
18	Bancolombia	Banking	LATAM	326		452	98%
19	Bybit floor	Crypto	Global	321		2,729	51%
20	IRS	Government	US	308		526	85%
21	O2	Telecom	UK	271		436	41%
22	Visa	Payments	Global	269		601	86%
23	Bradesco	Banking	LATAM	259		284	86%
24	BBVA	Banking	EU	233		255	82%
25	FedEx	Logistics	Global	218		345	66%
26	Mastercard	Payments	Global	214		284	79%
27	ATT floor	Telecom	US	207		1,186	61%
28	NHS floor	Health	UK	168		3,255	71%
29	SSA	Government	US	163		436	89%
30	Vodafone	Telecom	Global	161		343	75%
31	CashApp	Payments	US	156		238	55%
32	HSBC	Banking	UK	150		255	61%

The most impersonated single brand on this measure is **Alipay** (1,581 distinct domains, 99% of them carrying no form of the brand name). The composition of the top of this table is the substantive finding: it is dominated by **payment rails and mobile carriers**, not by banks. Those are the services with the widest population coverage and the lowest per-interaction scrutiny — a bill, a top-up or a transfer confirmation is mundane in a way a banking login is not.

Platform brands — upper bound

Reported separately and explicitly as a ceiling rather than a count. The true impersonation figure for each is materially lower.

#	Brand	Vertical	Region	Domains	Relative	Observations	No token
1	TikTok floor	Social	Global	3,696		16,711	95%
2	Instagram floor	Social	Global	3,498		26,013	99%
3	WhatsApp floor	Social	Global	3,231		14,753	97%
4	LinkedIn floor	Social	Global	3,173		7,311	97%
5	Shopify floor	Retail	Global	3,051		18,861	98%
6	Facebook floor	Social	Global	2,847		14,671	99%
7	Discord floor	Social	Global	2,796		5,746	95%
8	Google floor	Tech	Global	2,009		7,084	99%
9	Roblox floor	Gaming	Global	2,004		8,531	85%
10	Airbnb floor	Travel	Global	1,684		3,833	90%
11	Taobao floor	Retail	APAC	1,452		3,768	99%
12	eBay	Retail	Global	1,172		1,422	90%
13	Amazon	Tech	Global	1,079		1,263	92%
14	X_Twitter	Social	Global	1,055		1,376	92%
15	Telegram	Social	Global	1,035		1,269	95%
16	Apple floor	Tech	Global	956		2,345	90%
17	Spotify floor	Streaming	Global	910		3,241	88%
18	DisneyPlus	Streaming	Global	889		1,040	74%
19	Netflix floor	Streaming	Global	875		10,537	87%
20	Booking floor	Travel	Global	875		1,948	80%
21	Microsoft floor	Tech	Global	814		3,056	97%
22	Office365	Tech	Global	606		1,067	72%
23	Walmart	Retail	US	601		675	91%
24	Temu	Retail	Global	335		348	74%

By vertical

Unambiguous brands only, so these totals are comparable across rows.

Vertical	Domains	Relative	No token	Most targeted in vertical
Payments	5,864		93%	Alipay, Pix, WeChatPay, PayPal
Telecom	5,022		77%	Movistar, ChinaMobile, BT, EE
Banking	3,434		72%	Revolut, Santander, Bancolombia, Bradesco
Crypto	3,340		60%	Binance, OKX, TrustWallet, Ledger
Logistics	1,305		73%	USPS, DHL, FedEx, CorreosES
Government	809		75%	IRS, SSA, Gosuslugi, GovUK
Health	210		63%	NHS, Aetna, Bupa, UnitedHealth
Utilities	24		25%	EON, BritishGas, EDF, Electricireland

Payments leads with 5,864 domains, ahead of **Telecom** (5,022) and **Banking** (3,434). Two observations follow from the ordering.

- **Payments and telecom outrank banking.** That inverts the usual assumption. A carrier top-up page or a payment-rail confirmation reaches a far larger population than any single bank, and it is transacted casually. Banking impersonation is more valuable per victim but costs more to build and is more heavily monitored.
- **Government sits low on volume and high on consequence.** Tax and benefits impersonation is comparatively rare in this corpus, but it is seasonal and it targets people who cannot easily verify the approach through another channel.

By region

Region	Domains	Relative	No token	Most targeted in region
Global	5,411		66%	Binance, PayPal, OKX, TrustWallet
APAC	4,190		97%	Alipay, ChinaMobile, WeChatPay, UnionPay
UK	3,428		58%	BT, EE, Revolut, Santander
EU	2,457		85%	Movistar, BBVA, CorreosES, Gosuslugi
LATAM	2,343		92%	Pix, Bancolombia, Bradesco, MercadoPago
US	2,120		74%	USPS, IRS, ATT, SSA
IE	59		58%	Revenue_IE, BankOfIreland, PTSB, AnPost

Region here means brand reach, not attacker location. Nothing in this dataset tells us where an operator sits. What the regional split does show is which *national* institutions carry enough customer concentration to justify a dedicated campaign — which is the question a domestic defender actually needs answered.

National brands, Global excluded

#	Brand	Vertical	Region	Domains	Relative	Observations	No token
1	Alipay floor	Payments	APAC	1,581		3,017	99%
2	Movistar floor	Telecom	EU	1,481		1,550	97%
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18	SSA	Government	US	163		436	89%
19	CashApp	Payments	US	156		238	55%
20	HSBC	Banking	UK	150		255	61%
21	Monzo	Banking	UK	130		207	76%
22	MercadoPago	Payments	LATAM	122		144	82%

Where domain-name detection fails hardest

Across the unambiguous set, **77%** of impersonating domains contain no form of the brand name. Ranking by that share rather than by volume shows which brands are least protected by name-based monitoring. Only brands with 40 or more domains are listed, so the percentages are stable.

Brand	Vertical	Region	Domains	No token	Example domains
ChinaMobile	Telecom	APAC	1,243	100%	00-0af-----d-----f-----p.ques t, 003021.xyz, 00w6s.shop
WeChatPay	Payments	APAC	1,093	100%	0000263.com, 00009tv.com, 0001tv.com
Alipay	Payments	APAC	1,581	99%	0000263.com, 00009tv.com, 0001tv.com
Bancolombia	Banking	LATAM	326	98%	0vmcy5.click, 0wjmd6.site, 1nwzf8.site
Movistar	Telecom	EU	1,481	97%	01280719.site, 170426f4ct.online, 1cancdeud4-mv.site
Pix	Payments	LATAM	1,474	97%	001game73.com, 001gamee2.com, 001gamejj.com
Stripe	Payments	Global	140	90%	2031.link, 4combonetwork.com, 4webhub.com
SSA	Government	US	163	89%	04510-104.com, 51bangzhu.com, 84pixels.com
BankOfAmerica	Banking	US	90	89%	101eastkennedyhandbook.com, 1tcbu.com, advanceboa.com
USPS	Logistics	US	460	88%	019monioni.help, 0mxo.com, 102-12.com.au
Visa	Payments	Global	269	86%	1001creditcards.com, 1pay.by, 1xcasino-de.de
Bradesco	Banking	LATAM	259	86%	013bx.com, 123bonoscartoes.com, 3rsolucoesfinanceiras.com.br
IRS	Government	US	308	85%	10-4tax.com, 1031exchangemadesimple.com, 1040-form-printable.net
PayPal	Payments	Global	637	83%	027-paypal.com, 03-1010.de, 1001casino.info
BBVA	Banking	EU	233	82%	80yildiryarinarlodayiz-kayit.com, acik-web-gir.casa, actionevictionse rvic.com
MercadoPago	Payments	LATAM	122	82%	1winargentina-login.com, 1winoficial.com.ar, 20bet.cloud

The inverse deserves stating. The brands where name-based detection performs best here are BancoDoBrasil (73% token-bearing), ATO (65% token-bearing), EE (62% token-bearing), Trezor (60% token-bearing), Deutsche (60% token-bearing). Where attackers do build lookalike domains, a good permutation list earns its keep. The point is not that domain monitoring is useless — it is that its coverage swings from near-total to near-zero depending on the brand, and no team can tell which case they are in without measuring the rendered page.

Method and limits

Decision	Why
Ranked on distinct domains	Observation counts reward brands we happen to rescan often. Distinct domains measures attacker effort.
Month-sliced queries	The endpoint caps at 500 rows per query regardless of the size requested. Slicing by month and unioning removes that ceiling for all but the largest brands; 35 still saturate at least one month and are marked "floor".
Brands split by match ambiguity	The central correction in this report. A title match is a direct measure for a bank and an upper bound for a marketplace.
Disambiguated expressions	Short and dictionary-word brands are qualified — Visa excludes immigration, Steam excludes steam cleaning, Ledger excludes accounting, BT excludes BitTorrent.

Four limits to carry into any use of these numbers.

1. **This is our visibility, not the world.** A brand low in this table may be under-observed rather than under-attacked.
2. **The brand list bounds the answer.** We chose it; a brand not on it cannot appear.
3. **Volume is not harm.** Domain count says nothing about victims or losses. One well-distributed banking page can cost more than a thousand throwaway lures.
4. **Residual collision risk remains.** Context qualifiers were applied to every ambiguous brand and the BitTorrent, immigration and accounting senses were excluded explicitly, but we have not manually reviewed every matching page.

What we would do with this

- **Scope monitoring from the no-token column, not the volume column.** A brand above 90% no-token cannot be defended by name-based watchlists at all, whatever its rank.
- **Weight payments and telecom accordingly.** They outrank banking on impersonation volume in this corpus, and they are usually resourced as though they do not.
- **Use the national tables for domestic defence.** The Global bucket reflects brand reach; the regional tables show which national institutions justify a dedicated campaign.
- **Re-run on a cadence.** Eight months is a snapshot. The month-sliced method makes the trend cheap to reproduce, and trend is what makes this actionable.

Annex — all tracked brands

Both classes, ranked together. Platform brands are marked, and their figures remain an upper bound.

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40	DHL floor	Logistics	Global	362	1,190	62%

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43	Bybit floor	Crypto	Global	321	2,729	51%
44	IRS	Government	US	308	526	85%
45	MercadoLibre platform	Retail	LATAM	306	369	81%
46	Shein platform	Retail	Global	292	456	64%
47	O2	Telecom	UK	271	436	41%
48	Visa	Payments	Global	269	601	86%
49	Bradesco	Banking	LATAM	259	284	86%
50	BBVA	Banking	EU	233	255	82%
51	Uniswap platform floor	Crypto	Global	223	2,831	74%
52	FedEx	Logistics	Global	218	345	66%
53	Mastercard	Payments	Global	214	284	79%
54	ATT floor	Telecom	US	207	1,186	61%
55	NHS floor	Health	UK	168	3,255	71%
56	SSA	Government	US	163	436	89%
57	Vodafone	Telecom	Global	161	343	75%
58	IKEA platform	Retail	Global	159	175	65%
59	CashApp	Payments	US	156	238	55%
60	HSBC	Banking	UK	150	255	61%
61	Stripe	Payments	Global	140	151	90%
62	Monzo	Banking	UK	130	207	76%
63	MetaMask floor	Crypto	Global	129	4,105	71%
64	MercadoPago	Payments	LATAM	122	144	82%
65	Trezor floor	Crypto	Global	116	6,947	40%
66	CorreosES	Logistics	EU	115	179	68%
67	Steam platform	Gaming	Global	111	661	77%
68	Verizon	Telecom	US	98	138	51%
69	Phantom floor	Crypto	Global	96	1,308	67%
70	WellsFargo	Banking	US	93	159	82%
71	BankOfAmerica	Banking	US	90	300	89%
72	Gosuslugi	Government	EU	86	96	71%
73	BancoDoBrasil	Banking	LATAM	85	86	27%
74	Barclays	Banking	UK	84	150	64%
75	Tesco platform	Retail	UK	84	137	63%
76	EVAAir platform	Travel	APAC	75	77	100%
77	TMobile	Telecom	US	74	82	65%
78	OpenSea platform	Crypto	Global	72	841	78%
79	Chase	Banking	US	69	218	65%
80	Truist	Banking	US	64	120	47%
81	UnionPay	Payments	APAC	61	70	74%
82	GovUK	Government	UK	59	215	54%
83	ThreeUK	Telecom	UK	57	67	77%
84	HMRC	Government	UK	56	111	52%

#	Brand	Vertical	Region	Domains	Observations	No token
85	Target platform	Retail	US	55	56	58%
86	CapitalOne	Banking	US	54	127	72%
87	Sparkasse	Banking	EU	54	228	44%
88	Kraken	Crypto	Global	54	764	65%
89	USBank	Banking	US	52	54	58%
90	ChinaAirlines platform	Travel	APAC	52	60	96%
91	Zelle	Payments	US	49	59	69%
92	Orange	Telecom	EU	46	113	70%
93	ATO	Government	APAC	43	43	35%
94	Nubank	Banking	LATAM	42	42	62%
95	Revenue_IE	Government	IE	42	47	62%
96	Deutsche	Banking	EU	40	104	40%
97	CreditAgricole	Banking	EU	40	149	70%
98	UniCredit	Banking	EU	40	43	68%
99	BNPParibas	Banking	EU	39	45	59%
100	Commerzbank	Banking	EU	37	70	73%
101	Nationwide	Banking	UK	35	43	94%
102	Swedbank	Banking	EU	35	35	83%
103	Itau	Banking	LATAM	35	143	63%
104	RoyalMail	Logistics	UK	34	34	44%
105	CanadaPost	Logistics	US	34	36	79%
106	Ryanair platform	Travel	IE	34	48	76%
107	UPS	Logistics	Global	33	89	67%
108	NatWest	Banking	UK	31	36	35%
109	Venmo	Payments	US	31	34	84%
110	ICICI	Banking	APAC	30	36	67%
111	Wise	Payments	Global	30	33	20%
112	CommBank	Banking	APAC	26	30	77%
113	Aetna	Health	US	26	27	31%
114	Impots	Government	EU	25	26	80%
115	ChunghwaTelecom	Telecom	APAC	23	24	65%
116	Lufthansa platform	Travel	EU	23	26	39%
117	TDBank	Banking	US	22	24	23%
118	Schwab	Banking	US	22	40	45%
119	Nordea	Banking	EU	22	26	41%
120	SocieteGenerale	Banking	EU	20	22	70%
121	DVLA	Government	UK	20	22	40%
122	CaixaBank	Banking	EU	18	27	44%
123	PKOBP	Banking	EU	18	20	61%
124	Intesa	Banking	EU	17	38	76%
125	Bupa	Health	UK	16	18	31%
126	NavyFederal	Banking	US	15	81	60%
127	Citibank	Banking	US	15	18	87%
128	ABNAMRO	Banking	EU	13	16	62%

#	Brand	Vertical	Region	Domains	Observations	No token
129	OCBC	Banking	APAC	13	13	31%
130	ANZ	Banking	APAC	13	76	77%
131	Westpac	Banking	APAC	13	18	23%
132	NovaPoshta	Logistics	EU	13	17	62%
133	Fidelity	Banking	US	12	16	50%
134	Lloyds	Banking	UK	12	12	33%
135	AustraliaPost	Logistics	APAC	12	12	42%
136	Jio	Telecom	APAC	12	13	50%
137	EON	Utilities	EU	12	38	25%
138	Halifax	Banking	UK	11	11	73%
139	Rabobank	Banking	EU	11	11	64%
140	HDFC	Banking	APAC	10	63	80%
141	PostNL	Logistics	EU	10	10	80%
142	SBI	Banking	APAC	9	24	22%
143	BritishGas	Utilities	UK	9	11	33%
144	ING	Banking	EU	8	10	25%
145	BritishAirways platform	Travel	UK	8	97	50%
146	Emirates platform	Travel	Global	8	8	62%
147	AmericanExpress	Payments	Global	7	7	71%
148	DPD	Logistics	EU	7	9	57%
149	Telekom	Telecom	EU	7	14	43%
150	Diia	Government	EU	7	8	86%
151	PNC	Banking	US	6	6	67%
152	BankOfIreland	Banking	IE	6	9	50%
153	PTSB	Banking	IE	6	9	33%
154	TSB	Banking	UK	5	7	60%
155	DBS	Banking	APAC	5	5	20%
156	AnPost	Logistics	IE	5	7	60%
157	Sainsburys platform	Retail	UK	5	5	60%
158	Starling	Banking	UK	4	4	25%
159	EDF	Utilities	EU	3	3	0%
160	ICBC	Banking	APAC	2	3	0%
161	Evri	Logistics	UK	2	2	50%
162	NAB	Banking	APAC	1	1	0%
163	AIB	Banking	IE	0	0	0%
164	ElectricIreland	Utilities	IE	0	0	0%
165	UnitedHealth	Health	US	0	0	0%

Webamon corpus analysis. Counts derive from rendered page content observed between 1 January and 3 August 2026 and reflect the visibility of this corpus rather than global impersonation volume. Headline figures use only brands whose name is not attached to third-party content; platform brands are reported separately as an upper bound. Brands marked "floor" saturated the 500-row query limit in at least one month. No count derives from domain-string, permutation or certificate matching.